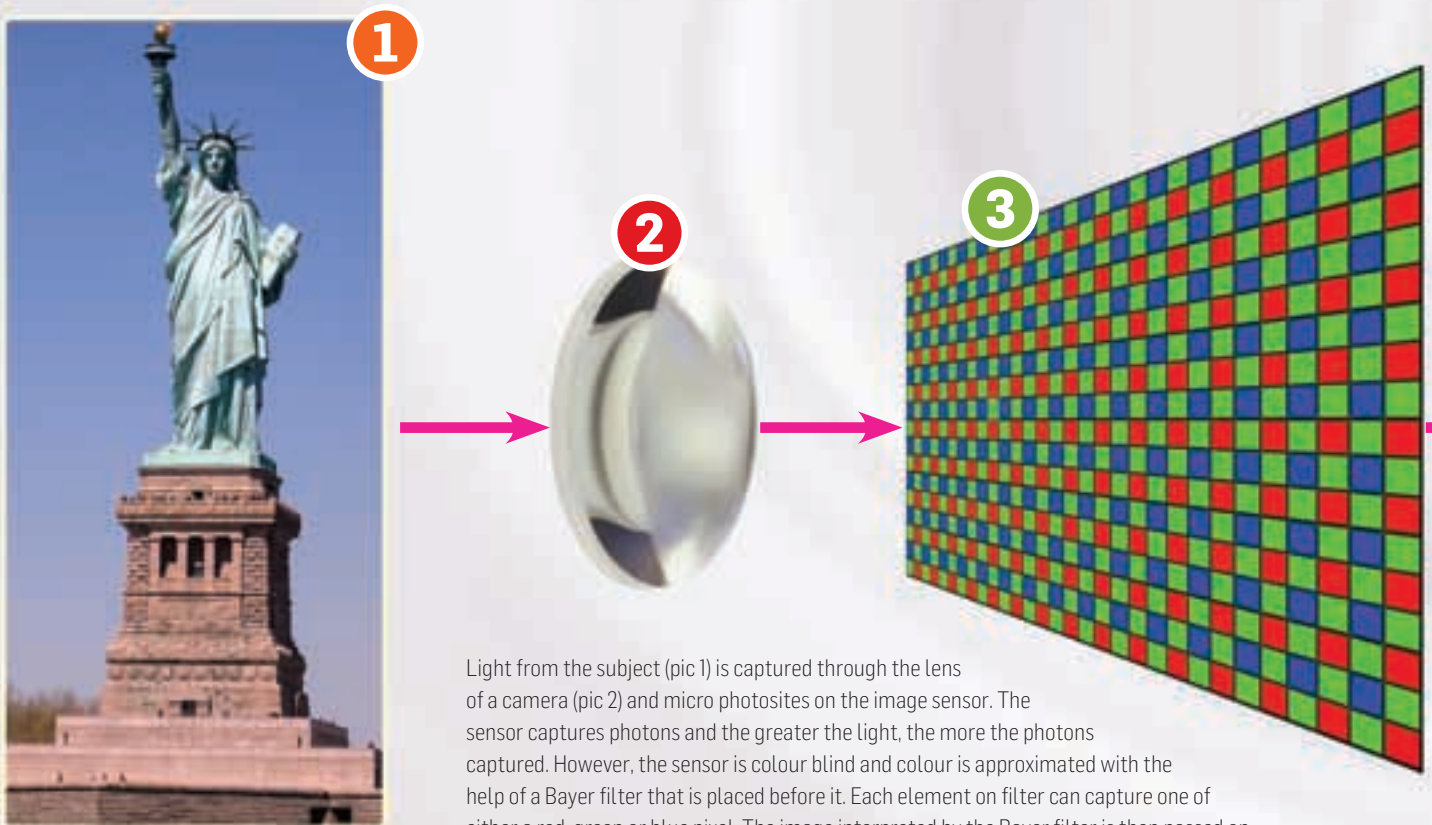


Digital Camera Sensor

From the most basic point-n-shoot camera to the largest medium format Phase One or Hasselblad, the core functioning portion of a digital camera remains its sensor. It is the sensor that is responsible for capturing light and converting it into an electrical signal. Or in pure physics terms, converting photons to electrons. To do this, the sensor must be able to record or capture this light in some way.



Light from the subject (pic 1) is captured through the lens of a camera (pic 2) and micro photosites on the image sensor. The sensor captures photons and the greater the light, the more the photons captured. However, the sensor is colour blind and colour is approximated with the help of a Bayer filter that is placed before it. Each element on filter can capture one of either a red, green or blue pixel. The image interpreted by the Bayer filter is then passed on to the raw image sensor of the camera (pic 4).

A camera sensor, whether CCD or CMOS, is made of silicon, and consists of a huge number of really tiny sites called photosites that are tiny cavities on the surface of the sensor that are sensitive to light.



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